

Government of Madhya Pradesh

Four Years into a Revolution



Four years versus sixty sounds like a pithy slogan, but set in the context of Madhya Pradesh it is much more than a slogan, it seems to be a mantra that is working. It has a remarkably true ring to it, when we actually get to see the progress that the state has made in a short span of past four years. A dramatic turnaround in a state mired in decades of neglect, inertia and chronic backwardness. Spectacular results across all development parameters that have not only silenced that sceptics and the staunchest critics, but have enthused the people of the state with a new hope and the belief, that miracles are possible, provided you have the political will and commitment.

The achievements of past four years clearly overshadow whatever little gains were made in the past six decades. It is not so long ago that when most states in the country were seized with the idea of economic reforms and industrial growth, Madhya Pradesh seemed to merely watching from the sidelines. When the present government took over the reigns, no one was too hopeful that the things will change. Yet four years is all it has taken to dispel the years of gloom.

After decades in wilderness, Madhya Pradesh is finally realising its potential. Promising a whopping Rs. 50,000 crore investment in the State in near future in fields as diverse as core sector like power and cement production to education, Anil Dhirubhai Ambani Group (ADAG) chairman Anil Ambani views Madhya Pradesh as the future energy capital of the country. He was the star attraction at the Global

Investors' Summit, 2007, organised by Madhya Pradesh Government in Indore on October 26-27, the first event of its kind ever in Madhya Pradesh, perhaps even among all the four BIMARU states. There are other top industrial houses eager to invest in Madhya Pradesh as well.

If industry is looking at Madhya Pradesh as the next big happening destination, it is not merely because of sops or incentives. It is because of the infrastructure. Huge strides have been made in this sector. This includes improved road network of 28,000 km, additional generation capacity of 3000 mw in power generation and of nearly four lakh hectare additional irrigation capacity. All this has been achieved within a short span of four years. The recently released Human Development Report 2007 focuses on infrastructure this year. It is the development on the ground that has inspired the confidence that things are on the move in this state, and this could well be the next success story of the country.

Even as the State Government plans another Global Investors' Meet in Jabalpur early next year, the final tally notched up by the end of the two-day exercise in Indore is hugely impressive. About 100 MoUs worth Rs. one lakh 14 thousand 256 crore were signed. As many as 400 domestic and 125 foreign delegates